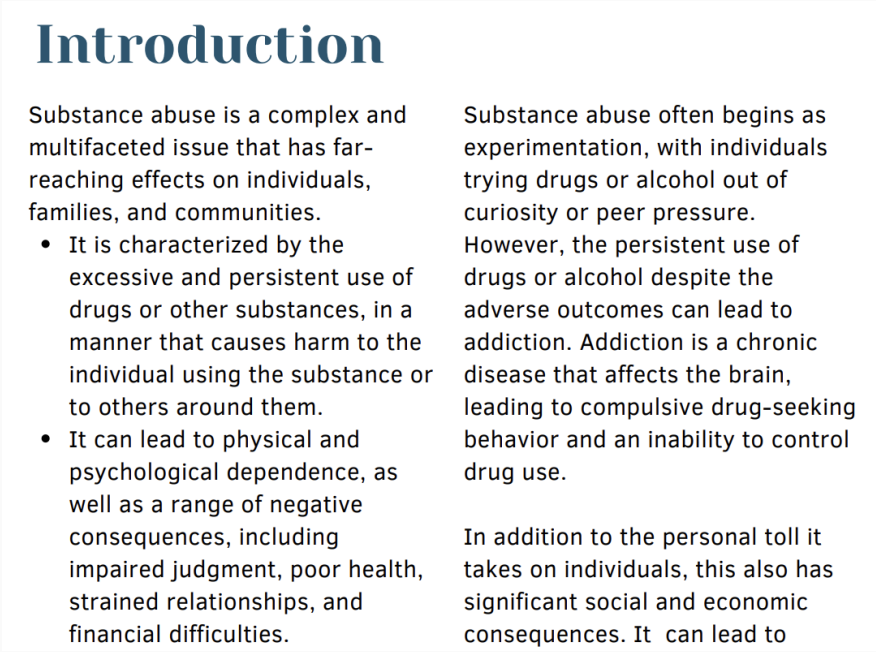


HOPE FOR RECOVERY

Newsletter by Hope for Recovery

Soumya Saxena - Content Writing and Editing

- I conducted a study that examined multiple crucial elements of substance abuse.
- Included relevant quotes in our newsletter that effectively promote awareness about substance abuse and inspire those who have been impacted by it my research and psychological well-being.
- I contributed to the editing process. I worked closely with my colleagues to ensure that the content was clear, concise, and easy to understand.



Introduction

Substance abuse is a complex and multifaceted issue that has far-reaching effects on individuals, families, and communities.

- It is characterized by the excessive and persistent use of drugs or other substances, in a manner that causes harm to the individual using the substance or to others around them.
- It can lead to physical and psychological dependence, as well as a range of negative consequences, including impaired judgment, poor health, strained relationships, and financial difficulties.

Substance abuse often begins as experimentation, with individuals trying drugs or alcohol out of curiosity or peer pressure. However, the persistent use of drugs or alcohol despite the adverse outcomes can lead to addiction. Addiction is a chronic disease that affects the brain, leading to compulsive drug-seeking behavior and an inability to control drug use.

In addition to the personal toll it takes on individuals, this also has significant social and economic consequences. It can lead to

Avantika Lohiya - Content Writing and Research

- Stages of substance abuse.
- How substance abuse affects education, family relations and employment and How to talk about addiction and recovery
- I conducted research to ensure that the content would be relevant and up-to-date
- I made an effort to use simple language that everyone could understand and I avoided using complicated words or technical terms as much as possible.



How to talk about addiction and recovery?

Addiction is a complex and sensitive topic that can be difficult to talk about. It affects people from all walks of life and can have a significant impact on individuals, families, and communities. However, discussing addiction and recovery is crucial in raising awareness, reducing stigma, and providing support to those who are struggling. In this article, we will discuss how to talk about addiction and recovery in a compassionate,

You can find reliable information from organizations such as the National Institute on Drug Abuse (NIDA) and the Substance Abuse and Mental Health Services Administration (SAMHSA).

4. Focus on the positives of recovery:
When talking about addiction, it's important to focus on the positives of recovery. Recovery is

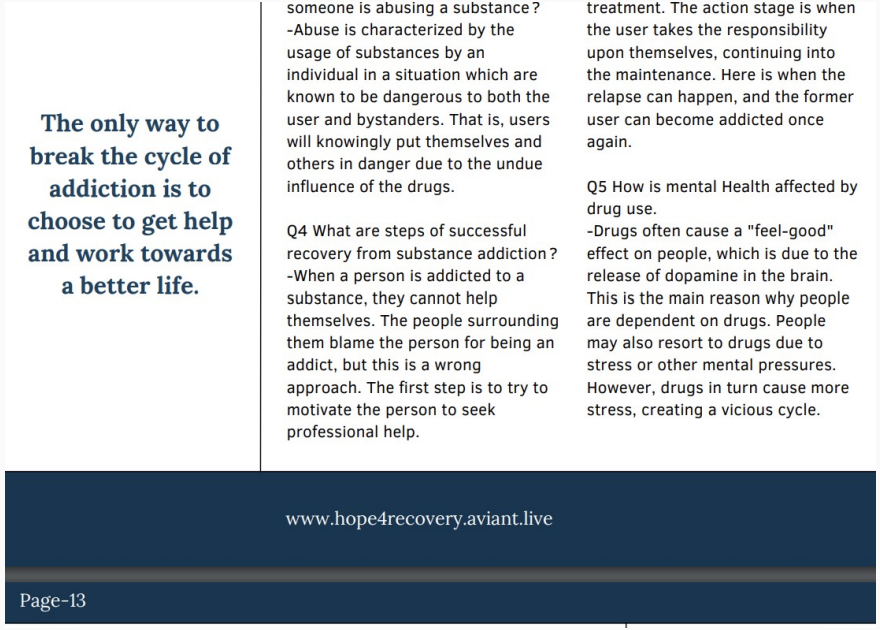
Jayesh Thakkar - Content writing and Proof-reading

- I worked as a content writer in 2 articles
- 1st job was to research and divided the topic in 4 or maximum 5 sub topics.
- I noted down the sub points and did individual research on them.
- I also framed the conclusion and sent the whole article.
- After that, it was my responsibility to proofread everything before creating the final draft.
- I checked plagiarism using grammarly and other free websites.



Niraj Lalani - Editing

- I was primarily a part of the newsletter editing team.
- I helped Ketakee by taking up her design and adding all Jayesh's, Samruddhi's articles in the newsletter and maintaining the structure.
- Provided the resources, I gathered in the website blog - photos, articles to refer and use in the newsletter.



The only way to break the cycle of addiction is to choose to get help and work towards a better life.

someone is abusing a substance?
-Abuse is characterized by the usage of substances by an individual in a situation which are known to be dangerous to both the user and bystanders. That is, users will knowingly put themselves and others in danger due to the undue influence of the drugs.

Q4 What are steps of successful recovery from substance addiction?
-When a person is addicted to a substance, they cannot help themselves. The people surrounding them blame the person for being an addict, but this is a wrong approach. The first step is to try to motivate the person to seek professional help.

treatment. The action stage is when the user takes the responsibility upon themselves, continuing into the maintenance. Here is when the relapse can happen, and the former user can become addicted once again.

Q5 How is mental Health affected by drug use.
-Drugs often cause a "feel-good" effect on people, which is due to the release of dopamine in the brain. This is the main reason why people are dependent on drugs. People may also resort to drugs due to stress or other mental pressures. However, drugs in turn cause more stress, creating a vicious cycle.

Samruddhi Patodi - Content writing and Editing

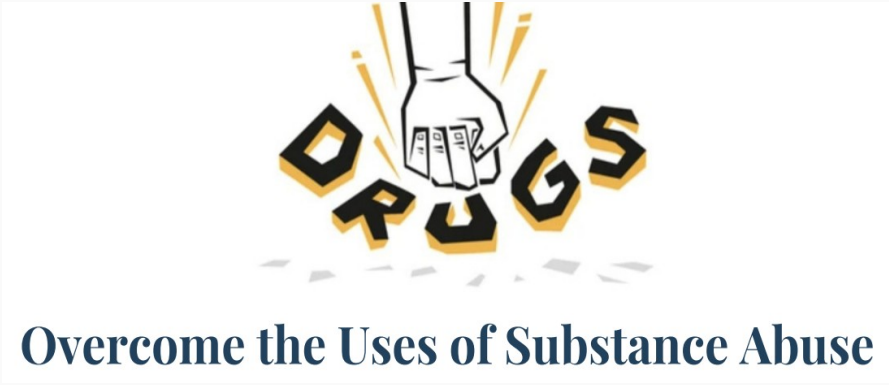
- I was responsible for content writing of 3 articles.
- I researched a few websites and understood the main emotion and noted that down into a few points.
- I researched many websites and rea news article and listed the points mentioned in the news letter.
- I also added statistical facts and **"Do you Know?"**



Indian Government's efforts to combat Substance abuse

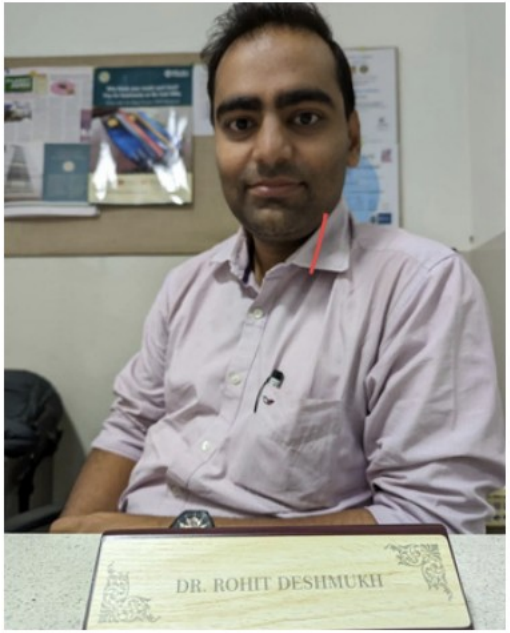
Ketakee Joshi - Content writing, Designing and Editing

- Prepared the editor's note and index, which talks comprehensive overview of the subject of drug addiction and substance abuse.
- I wrote the article about overcoming substance abuse.
- I also contributed in adding **“Myths and facts”**
- I was the part of the designing team where we handpicked images that resonated with the blue theme of our campaign.



Om Herwadkar - Content writing.

- I noted down the interview with Dr Rohit Deshmukh conducted by my teammate Shubham.
- I paraphrased and rewrote it in streamlined language to make it easily understandable and emphasize the salient points.
- This would make it easy to peruse through the interview and understand the points Dr Rohit Deshmukh made in a short time.



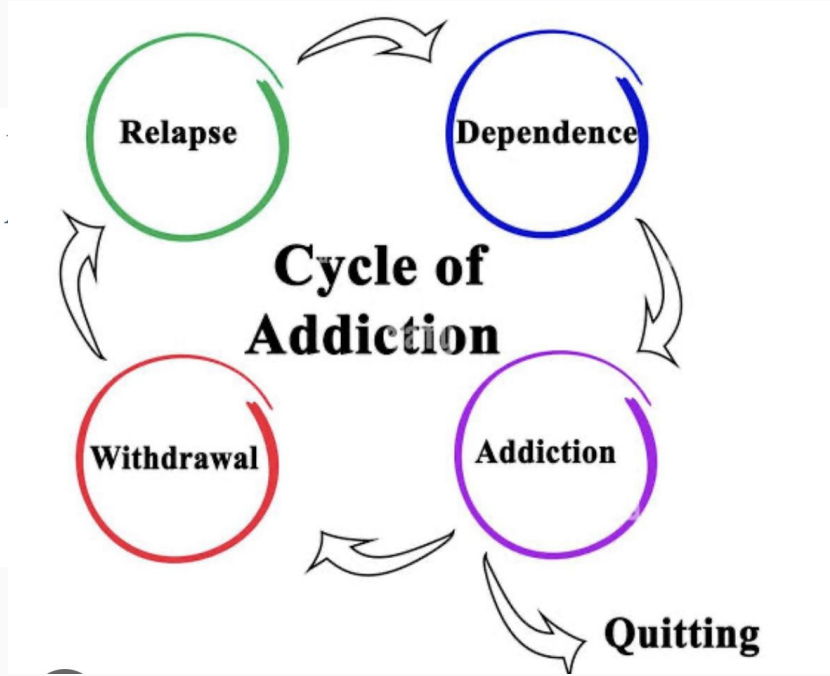
Nisarg Khodke - Content writing

- I wrote on the topic of **“Causes and impacts of substance abuse”** and
- M



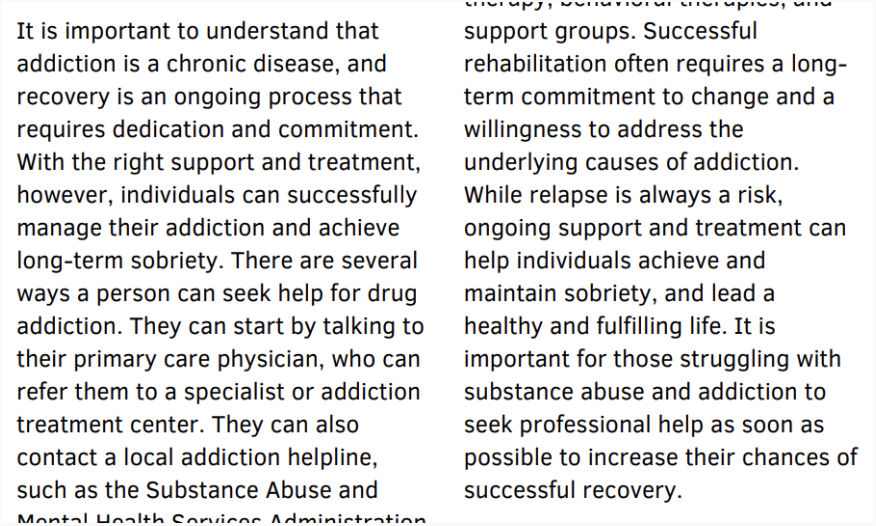
Prithvi Bajaj - Presentation and Research

- Research and content on stages of substance abuse.
- I spoke to someone I know who has been through all three stages of substance abuse, went through recovery and has been doing well ever since. She helped us clear out misconceptions regarding this issue and shared her real life experiences
- Making of the presentation



Keyah Gandhi - Presentation and Research

- I helped in the making of the presentation by cutting down information from the newsletter according to content researched by individual members.
- Worked on the conclusion of the newsletter and researched along with Samruddhi
- Helped working on the grammatical errors in the newsletter.

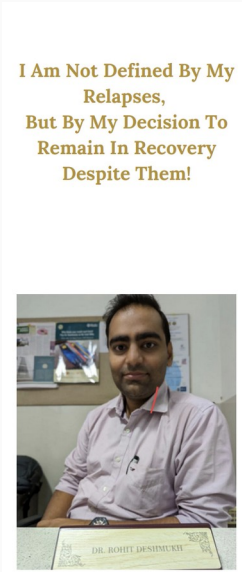


It is important to understand that addiction is a chronic disease, and recovery is an ongoing process that requires dedication and commitment. With the right support and treatment, however, individuals can successfully manage their addiction and achieve long-term sobriety. There are several ways a person can seek help for drug addiction. They can start by talking to their primary care physician, who can refer them to a specialist or addiction treatment center. They can also contact a local addiction helpline, such as the Substance Abuse and

support groups. Successful rehabilitation often requires a long-term commitment to change and a willingness to address the underlying causes of addiction. While relapse is always a risk, ongoing support and treatment can help individuals achieve and maintain sobriety, and lead a healthy and fulfilling life. It is important for those struggling with substance abuse and addiction to seek professional help as soon as possible to increase their chances of successful recovery.

Shubham Tanna - Presentation and Expert interview

- Reached out to top psychiatrists in and around Andheri to conduct a live interview session with.
- Negotiated with said experts for their time and insights.
- Brainstormed and attempted to form comprehensive questions to ask in the interview with Dr. Rohit Deshmukh.
- Made the presentation



A Brief Talk with Dr. Rohit Deshmukh

Q1 What is substance abuse?
-Substance abuse is the consumption of a large amount of a certain substance for an extended period of time, till the point of dependency. Abuse is different form addiction which is the physical and psychological dependency on the substance.

Q2 What are the psychological and physical effects of substance abuse?
-Different substances have different effects, causing CNS depression, resulting in a lack of inhibitions. However, this is just a short term effect. There are also long term effects distinct from short term effects that are harmful to the

Psychiatrists try and determine the motivation level of the person first. If they are motivated, then they can start on the treatment immediately. This involves detoxification and then psychological therapy which is different for every person and depends on their lifestyle.

The cycle of motivation is Pre-contemplation, contemplation, preparation, action, maintenance and relapse. The pre contemplation stage is when the user has no control over their addiction and needs an intervention by their peers. The contemplation stage is when the person realizes that they have a problem, and it is this part that psychiatrists target. The